

# Otto Carlo Hofer, PhD

Based in Amsterdam, NL · carlo.hofer.phd@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/carlo-hofer

## PROFILE

Quantitative political scientist (PhD, University of Warwick, pass with no corrections). Research on media, geography, and political attitudes in Europe, combining panel data, causal-inference designs, geospatial analysis, and survey experiments. Currently postdoctoral researcher at Queen Mary University of London on the Horizon Europe DEMETRA project.

## CURRENT POSITION

**Postdoctoral Research Associate, Queen Mary University of London**

May 2024 – Present

*Horizon Europe DEMETRA project on deliberative policy-making · PI: Prof. Maria Grasso*

- Coordinate scientific work across 11 institutions and 7 countries against fixed European Commission deadlines; end-to-end ownership of project-wide deliverables, including two policy briefs co-developed with four work-package leaders and addressed to a mixed audience of EC stakeholders, national and local policymakers, municipalities, and practitioners.
- Drafted the project's ethics plan, data management plan, communication plan, and dissemination & exploitation plan; prepared the periodic project report for the European Commission reviewers.
- Central ethics-approval lead for the consortium: QMUL is the project's host institution, so I run ethics applications across all work packages and liaise with partner institutions on local approvals.
- Field researcher on the qualitative work package: semi-structured interviews and participant observation in deliberative settings.
- Lead organiser of two QMUL-hosted events: the DEMETRA consortium meeting (May 2024) and the Politics and Society Workshop co-sponsored by DEMETRA and the DESPO ERC project (Mar 2026); built and run the project's external presence (website, multi-platform social media, partner video content).

## EDUCATION

**PhD, Quantitative Political Science, University of Warwick**

2020 – 2026

Thesis: *Exposure structures and intergroup attitudes in the UK: Linking media infrastructure and residential environments to affective polarisation and immigration attitudes.*

Supervisors: Prof. Vincenzo Bove, Dr Andreas Murr. Examiners: Prof. Peter Thisted Dinesen (Copenhagen), Prof. Özlem Atikcan (Warwick). Outcome: pass with no corrections (highest UK outcome).

Two empirical projects on the British Election Study Internet Panel (2015–2020, 100,000+ observations across 11 waves): (i) the link between online information consumption and political affective polarisation, using within-person fixed-effects, an instrumental-variables design exploiting local broadband performance, and Granger-inspired cross-lagged panel models; (ii) the link between neighbourhood ethnic segregation and immigration attitudes, using indices of evenness and exposure computed at the MSOA level (geolocated panel, ~7,200 areas), matched to LTIM migration flows and Townsend deprivation.

**MSc, Management, Ca' Foscari University of Venice**

2018 – 2020

110/110 cum laude (highest Italian grade) · GPA 29.5/30 · dissertation on education and political participation (full marks).

**BSc, Business with Computer Science, Technical University of Munich**

2014 – 2018

Bachelor's thesis grade 1.0 (top 1%); monetary prize from AutoScout24 for industry-partnered dissertation.

### Visiting Research Positions

University of Amsterdam (Jun–Aug 2024) · King's College London (Jan–Jun 2024) · EUTOPIA Visiting PhD, University of Gothenburg (Apr–May 2023).

## PUBLICATIONS AND WORKING PAPERS

### Refereed journal articles

Co-author. "Polarising punchlines: The influence of intergroup humour on partisan affective polarisation." Revise & resubmit, *Political Studies*.

### In preparation

Sole-authored. "Downloading polarisation: Online information consumption and political affective polarisation in the UK." PhD project, target submission 2026.

Sole-authored. "Good neighbours? Neighbourhood segregation and attitudes toward immigration in the UK." PhD project, target submission 2026.

Lead author. "Breaking the ice: The impact of humorous communication on climate change attitudes and political participation." Working paper from the ESRC humour project.

Co-author. "'OK Boomer': The influence of humour on intergenerational hostility and polarisation." Working paper from the ESRC humour project.

Lead author. "Ecological and economic cost of terror: The impact of terrorist attacks on London commuting patterns." Working paper from the Home Office–advised project (Warwick, 2022).

### Policy briefs and data deposits

- Two DEMETRA project policy briefs (co-developed with the consortium; addressed to European Commission stakeholders, national and local policymakers, municipalities, and practitioners; revised versions resubmitting June 2026).

- Four datasets from the ESRC humour project deposited on UK Data Service ReShare (survey + three pre-registered survey experiments; in final editorial review).

## EARLIER ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

---

### Research Associate, Queen Mary University of London

Oct 2023 – Apr 2024

ESRC project “The Impact of Political Humour on Political Attitudes and Behaviours” · PI: Prof. Maria Grasso

- Co-designed one survey and three pre-registered survey experiments on climate communication, intergroup humour, and intergenerational hostility; led ethics applications and roll-out.
- Lead-authored working paper on humorous climate communication; co-authored two further papers (one under R&R at Political Studies).
- Deposited four study datasets on the UK Data Service ReShare repository (in final editorial review).

### Research Associate (UK Home Office advisory), University of Warwick

Jul – Dec 2022

ESRC project on terrorism and well-being · PI: Prof. Vincenzo Bove

- Quantified the impact of terrorism on London public transport using high-frequency TfL ridership data (15-minute check-in/check-out); briefed Home Office officials on the results.
- Built the project's geospatial layer in Python and the Google Maps API (road distance/travel time between stations); estimated radius of effect via a non-parametric procedure.

### Senior Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Warwick

Sep 2021 – Sep 2023

- Sole tutor (under the module leader) for Introduction to Quantitative Political Analysis (BSc Politics) in 2021–22; delivered seminars and computer classes for Quantitative Political Analysis I and II.

### Research Assistant, Ca' Foscari University of Venice (Banca IFIS engagement)

May – Nov 2019

- Quantitative screening of 700+ SME financial statements; co-designed and conducted the qualitative interview phase with selected business owners; contributed to the PI's final presentation to Banca IFIS senior management.

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND WORKSHOPS

---

- “Breaking the ice: The impact of humorous communication on climate change attitudes and political participation.” MPSA Annual Conference, Chicago (2024); PSA Annual Conference, Glasgow (2024); Politics and Society Workshop (DEMETRA & DESPO ERC), QMUL (2026).
- “Media consumption and affective polarisation.” SISP General Conference, Genoa (2023); EPOP Annual Conference, Newcastle (2022); ECPR General Conference, Innsbruck (2022); in-house seminars, University of Gothenburg and University of Warwick (2022).
- “Segregation and anti-immigration attitudes.” SISP General Conference, Genoa (2023); EPOP Annual Conference, Southampton (2023).
- “Economic and ecological cost of terror in London.” UK Home Office internal conference, London (2023).
- Invited project talks: DEMETRA progress and findings presented to sister Horizon Europe consortia — RETOOL project meeting (Feb 2025), RETOOL synthesis workshop (Jun 2025), and CO-SUSTAIN stakeholder webinar (Mar 2026).
- DEMETRA project meetings: QMUL (May 2024, organiser), online (Oct 2024), Uppsala University (Apr 2025), online (Oct 2025), University of Lille (Apr 2026).
- ECPR Summer School “Quasi-experimental Methods for Causal Inference” with Elias Dinas (2020).

## ACADEMIC SERVICE AND ORGANISING

---

- Lead organiser: DEMETRA consortium meeting, QMUL (May 2024); Politics and Society Workshop co-sponsored by DEMETRA and the DESPO ERC project, QMUL (Mar 2026).
- Organising committee and chair, international conference “Terrorism, Public Attitudes and Individual Well-being,” University of Warwick (2022).
- Co-founder and co-chair, Quantitative Solutions & Networking Series, University of Warwick (2022); co-chair, CRIPS graduate working group, Warwick (2020–21).

## FUNDING AND AWARDS

---

- PhD scholarship (full fees + living stipend), University of Warwick (2020–2024).
- EUTOPIA Visiting PhD scholarship (€5,000), University of Gothenburg (2022).
- Doctoral College Fund, University of Warwick.
- Research assistant scholarship, Ca' Foscari University of Venice (2019).
- AutoScout24 monetary prize (€1,000) for BSc dissertation with full marks (top 1%), 2018.

## METHODS, TOOLS, AND LANGUAGES

---

Quantitative methods: panel-data analysis · within-person fixed-effects · cross-lagged / dynamic panel models · instrumental variables · survey design and pre-registered survey experiments · geospatial analysis (100m–MSOA scales) · segregation indices (dissimilarity, Theil's H, isolation).

Qualitative methods: semi-structured interviewing · participant observation · field research.

Tools: R · Stata · Python · SQL · Google Maps API · LaTeX · Git · Markdown.

Qualifications: GRE General 333 (top 2%) · IELTS Academic 8.5 (C2).

Languages: Italian (native) · German (native) · English (C2) · Dutch (C1, conversational and capable of teaching) · Spanish (B2) · French (B1) · Mandarin (A2).